



Visual identity and interface standards for the consultant placement platform. Authority, precision, and trust – in every pixel.

PRODUCT
ConsultIQ

01 — DESIGN PRINCIPLES

What guides every decision

Six principles govern all design choices within the ConsultIQ system. They are not aspirational — they are mandatory.

CLARITY Every interface element must communicate its purpose instantly. Labels, data displays, and interactions require no guesswork.	CONSISTENCY Visual patterns, component behaviours, and terminology must remain uniform across all views and user roles.	AUTHORITY The interface projects confidence and competence. Design reinforces trust in recommendations and scoring outputs.
SIMPLICITY Complexity is hidden behind clean interfaces. The engine's sophistication is felt in results, not imposed through clutter.	RESPONSIVENESS Layouts adapt gracefully to desktop, tablet, and mobile viewports without loss of functionality or legibility.	ACCESSIBILITY The system is usable by individuals of diverse abilities. No feature is inaccessible due to a design choice.

02 — COLOUR PALETTE

The ConsultIQ palette

Deep navy and professional blues project credibility. Gold conveys precision and quality. All combinations meet WCAG 2.1 AA contrast requirements.

Dark Blue (Primary) #002D62 Navigation, headings, primary buttons, banners	Blue (Secondary) #3C5A8A Sub-headings, links, active states, secondary buttons	Gold (Accent) #C9A84C Score highlights, featured tags, CTA emphasis	Light Surface #F4F6FA Page backgrounds, card backgrounds, sidebars
Mid Grey #E2E8F0 Dividers, table borders, input field borders	Dark Grey #4A5568 Body text on dark surfaces, secondary labels	Body Text #1F2937 Primary body copy, table content, form labels	Subtle Text #6B7280 Placeholders, metadata, timestamps, footnotes

Type scale & hierarchy

Calibri is the primary typeface. Courier New is reserved for code, score values, and data identifiers. Both are universally available without web font loading.

PAGE TITLE / H1 Calibri · Bold	Consultant Dashboard	28–32pt	Bold
SECTION TITLE / H2 Calibri · Bold	Top Matches This Week	20–22pt	Bold
SUB-HEADING / H3 Calibri · SemiBold	Project Requirements	16–18pt	SemiBold
BODY TEXT Calibri · Regular	The fit score engine evaluates consultants against project requirements across skills, experience, and availability. Results are ranked by match quality.	11–12pt	Regular
LABEL / CAPTION Calibri · Regular	LAST UPDATED · 2 HOURS AGO	9–10pt	Regular
CODE / ID VALUE Courier New · Regular	SCORE_92.4 · ID-00847	10pt	Regular

Icon system

Lucide Icons — outlined style, 2px stroke weight. Filled icons are reserved for active or selected states only.

							
Search	User	Project	Analytics	Settings	Filter	Alerts	CV / Doc

Standard sizes: 16px inline · 20px button · 24px navigation · 32px feature highlight. All standalone icons must include `aria-label` for screen readers.

Button system

Three semantic button types, each serving a distinct role. Never use a Danger button without a confirmation dialog.

Add Consultant	Filter	Remove Consultant	Disabled
PRIMARY	SECONDARY	DANGER	DISABLED

Primary Button Background: #1B2F5E Text: White · Bold Radius: 6px · Padding: 10/20px	Secondary Button Background: White Border: 1px Steel Blue Text: Steel Blue · Bold	Danger Button Background: #B91C1C Always confirm before action White text · Bold
--	---	--

Forms & inputs

Clean, accessible form elements. Focus ring uses Steel Blue to clearly indicate keyboard focus state.

Consultant Name e.g. Sipho Dlamini	Primary Skill e.g. Data Engineering
Years of Experience 0	Availability Select availability

07 — COMPONENTS · CARDS

Card components

Cards are the primary display unit for consultant and project data. Prefer cards over tables for all data display.

AVAILABLE

Amahle Nkosi

Senior Data Engineer · 7 years

Python

Spark

dbt

SQL

94.2

Fit Score
Project: FinOps Rebuild

View →

TOP MATCH

Lerato Mokoena

Cloud Architect · 10 years

AWS

Terraform

K8s

97.8

Fit Score
Project: Cloud Migration

View →

ON PROJECT

Thabo Sithole

UX Researcher · 5 years

Figma

Usability

Research

81.5

Fit Score
Project: Portal Redesign

View →

Background: White · Border: 1px #E2E8FO · Radius: 8px · Shadow: 0 2px 8px rgba(0,0,0,0.06) · Padding: 20px

08 — COMPONENTS · NAVIGATION

Sidebar navigation

Fixed sidebar present on all authenticated screens. Active items are indicated by a gold left border and subtle highlight.

consultIQ

Consultants

Add Consultant

Carol Nkosi

Senior Data Engineer

94.2 fit

Maya Mokoena

Cloud Architect

97.8 fit

Gift Sithole

UX Researcher

81.5 fit

Botho Dube

Business Analyst

88.1 fit

09 — COMPONENTS · MODALS

Modals & dialogs

Used for confirmations and quick actions. Buttons are right-aligned in the footer. Danger actions always require a confirmation modal.

Remove Consultant

Are you sure you want to remove Amahle Nkosi from the active consultant pool? This action cannot be undone and will affect active placement recommendations.

Cancel

Remove Consultant

10 — SPACING & LAYOUT

8px grid system

All spacing, padding, and margin values must be multiples of 8px to ensure visual rhythm and alignment consistency.

- 8px

Icon gap, tight component padding
- 16px

Card padding, card grid gap (compact)
- 24px

Card grid gap (standard), sidebar padding
- 32px

Section padding top/bottom
- 48px

Large section gaps, hero padding
- 64px

Page section top padding, major whitespace

MAX CONTENT WIDTH 1280px Horizontally centred	SIDEBAR WIDTH 240px Fixed, collapses on mobile	LAYOUT ENGINE Flex / Grid CSS only, no floats
--	---	--

11 — ACCESSIBILITY

WCAG 2.1 Level AA

All colour combinations, interactive elements, and content must meet or exceed WCAG 2.1 AA as a minimum standard.

White on Deep Navy — body copy at minimum White #FFF on #1B2F5E 12.4:1 AA + AAA	Body text on white background #1F2937 on #FFFFFF 16.7:1 AA + AAA	White on Steel Blue — normal text White #FFF on #3A6EA5 4.7:1 AA
---	--	--

Keyboard Navigation

- All interactive elements must be keyboard-operable
- Tab order: top-to-bottom, left-to-right
- Modals trap focus when open
- Focus ring: Gold #C9A84C · 2px · offset 2px

Screen Reader Requirements

- All images need descriptive alt text
- Decorative images use `alt=""`
- Inputs linked to labels via `htmlFor`
- Semantic HTML: `nav`, `main`, `section`, `button`

12 — RESPONSIVE DESIGN

Three breakpoints

Mobile-first design. Layouts adapt gracefully across all viewport sizes without loss of functionality.

Mobile < 768px • Single-column layout • Navigation collapses to hamburger drawer • Cards stack vertically • Tables scroll horizontally	Tablet 768px – 1023px • Two-column card grid • Sidebar collapses to toggle panel • Primary navigation remains visible • Form inputs full width	Desktop ≥ 1024px • Full sidebar always visible • 3–4 column card grid • Data tables show all columns • Max content width: 1280px
--	---	---

13 — TONE & MESSAGING

Voice & messaging standards

All in-system text must be professional, direct, concise, and actionable. Error messages must state the problem and how to resolve it.

CORRECT — DO THIS

✓ CORRECT USAGE
Error message "Consultant ID is required. Enter a valid 6-digit identifier to continue."

INCORRECT — AVOID THIS

X AVOID THIS
Too vague "Something went wrong! Please try again later or contact support."

Empty state

"No placements found. Adjust the date range or project filter to view results."

Confirmation

"Consultant removed. This action cannot be undone."

Too casual

"Oops, looks like you forgot to fill this bit out!"

Too technical

"HTTP 422 Unprocessable Entity: constraint violation on field consultant_id."

ALWAYS

Professional and direct

Concise — fewest words for clarity

Actionable — what happened + how to fix it

NEVER

Casual language or slang

Overly technical jargon

Vague messages without resolution path

14 — LOGO & BRAND MARK

Logo usage

The ConsultIQ logo consists of a wordmark (“consultIQ”) combined with a magnifying glass and brain icon, representing intelligent search and analysis. The logo should be used consistently to maintain brand recognition.



Full-colour on light backgrounds

“consult” in neutral grey (#4A5568), “IQ” and icon in blue (#3A6EA5).



Monochrome on dark backgrounds

White or light monochrome version to ensure contrast and visibility.

Restricted Usage

The logo colours must not be replaced with the primary palette (e.g., deep navy or gold), except for approved monochrome variations. Do not alter the proportions between the icon and the wordmark.